OLI BAKALA

AI Engineer | Machine Learning Engineer | Data Engineer

Addis Ababa, Ethiopia | **+251 946 217 631** | **olibekele50@gmail.com** | **github.com/21Oli** | **linkedin.com/in/oli-bakala/**

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software Engineering graduate with specialized AI and Data Science training through the Qiyas–Addis Ababa University program and hands-on experience developing machine learning solutions. Proficient in Python and familiar with machine learning, predictive modeling, NLP, computer vision, and data-driven application development. Combines software engineering fundamentals, analytical thinking, and problem-solving skills to build practical AI solutions, with a strong interest in generative AI, large language models (LLMs), and AI application integration. Eager to contribute to AI engineering projects while continuously developing expertise in AI frameworks, APIs, and deployment practices.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Programming & Data:** Python, JavaScript, Pandas, NumPy, SQL, data preprocessing, statistics, visualization
- **Machine Learning:** Scikit-learn, XGBoost, LightGBM, CatBoost, supervised learning, ensemble methods, feature engineering, SHAP
- **Deep Learning & CV:** TensorFlow, PyTorch, CNNs, OpenCV, face recognition, GPU-based experimentation
- **NLP & GenAI:** RAG, LLM, AI Agent, TF-IDF, text classification, tokenization, Seq2Seq, attention, Transformers, Hugging Face concepts
- **Data & Backend:** PostgreSQL, FastAPI, MongoDB, MySQL, Firebase, Node.js, Express.js, REST APIs
- **Engineering:** Git, GitHub, Postman, Streamlit, Flutter, React, Docker/FastAPI/MLflow/Airflow familiarity

EDUCATION

BSc in Software Engineering | Arba Minch University **2021 - 2025**

CGPA 3.71/4.00 | Passed National Exit Exam

AI & DATA ENGINEERING TRAINING

Qiyas - Addis Ababa University | AI & Data Engineering Training **16 May 2026 - 21 September 2026**

Python, Data Preprocessing & Analysis, Statistics, Machine Learning, Model Evaluation, Deep Learning, NLP, Computer Vision, Predictive Modeling, RAG, LLM, AI Agent, Git/GitHub

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Full-Stack Developer Intern | Dan Energy, Ethiopia **April 2024 - July 2024**

- Developed SkillUp, an e-learning platform using the MERN stack.
- Built responsive dashboards for students, instructors, and administrators.
- Integrated Firebase authentication and a discussion forum to support collaboration.

SELECTED AI / ML PROJECTS

• **AI-Powered Ethiopian Crop Yield Prediction** | ***AI / ML / Data Engineering***

Built an end-to-end ML pipeline integrating agricultural, farm, weather, and market data to predict crop yields in Ethiopia, with an interactive Streamlit demo.

• **AcademicGuard** | ***RAG / pgvector / LLMs / Next.js / n8n***

AI-powered plagiarism detection platform using RAG, pgvector semantic search, and LLMs — with a Next.js dashboard and n8n automation.

• **Credit Scoring & Probability of Default** | ***Feature Selection / XGBoost / LightGBM / CatBoost / SHAP***

Built an end-to-end credit scoring model for Probability of Default prediction using feature selection (Correlation, Information Value, SHAP) and comprehensive model benchmarking across gradient boosting algorithms.

• **AI-Powered Visual Attendance System** | ***Computer Vision / AI Engineering***

Developing a live-camera attendance system using Python and face-recognition technologies, with employee identification, attendance recording, and production-oriented architecture.

• **Neural Machine Translation** | ***Deep Learning / NLP***

Developing a neural sequence-to-sequence translation project covering tokenization, sequence modeling, attention and Transformer concepts, training, validation, and GPU-based experimentation.

• **Restaurant Sales Forecasting** | ***Time-Series / Machine Learning***

Built a forecasting pipeline from historical sales using lag features, rolling statistics, Random Forest and other ML approaches, with horizon-specific evaluation.

PRODUCTION-ORIENTED AI / ML & DATA STACK

Familiarity / Learning: Docker, FastAPI, MLflow, Apache Airflow, PostgreSQL, Hugging Face Transformers, AWS/Cloud concepts, CI/CD concepts

SOFTWARE ENGINEERING FOUNDATION

React, Node.js, Express.js, JavaScript, Flutter, MongoDB, Firebase, MySQL, PostgreSQL, FastAPI, REST APIs, Postman, Git/GitHub

CERTIFICATION

AI & Data Engineering Training — Qiyas / Addis Ababa University / Ethiopian Ministry of Labour and Skills | 2026

LANGUAGES

English (Fluent) • Amharic (Native) • Afaan Oromo (Native)